wealthy and worldly Frankish nobleman named Aimery of Limoges, to lend him the necessary funds. Aimery, who hadn't approved of the marriage in the first place, refused; so Raynald had his henchmen waylay the patriarch and beat him up. Then, says William of Tyre, Raynald "forced the aged priest . . . although an almost helpless invalid, to sit in the blazing sun throughout a summer's day, his bare head smeared with honey." After a few hours on top of the Antioch citadel, battling the insects, the patriarch handed over the funds.[4]

This childish exercise in power was followed by a much more serious action: Reynald approached one of Manuel's bitterest enemies and proposed an alliance.

This was Thoros II, the exiled prince of Cilician Armenia. His kingdom had been overrun by Manuel's father twenty years earlier, and Thoros II, probably still in his teens, had been taken to Constantinople in chains along with his father the king and his older brother. Both had died in captivity; only Thoros had survived, escaping from his prison in 1142 by some unknown means and returning to his occupied country. He had been fighting a desperate guerrilla war ever since, with its high point in 1152 when he managed to kill the local Byzantine governor.

At Raynald's suggestion, the two men joined together into an anti-Byzantine assault force; with the patriarch's money, they sacked a few outposts and then headed for the island of Cyprus. Cyprus, unaccustomed to war, had only a small garrison, headed up by the Emperor Manuel's own nephew. The combined Antiochene-Armenian troops overwhelmed the garrison and, given free reign by their commanders, proceeded to murder and sack their way through the island. Crops burned, herds were stolen; the old and young who fell in their way were viciously slaughtered, the women raped. Gregory the Priest writes that Raynald, in a gesture of mockery, had the noses of the priests cut off, and sent them back to Constantinople to present themselves to the emperor.[5]

Manuel was furious. The Normans had been a strong foe; Raynald was merely an annoyance to be swatted. In person, Manuel led a massive Byzantine army across into Cilicia and rapidly retook the land Thoros had claimed; Thoros escaped to a ruined castle deep in the mountains just in time.

Raynald was not so lucky. When he got news of the size of the approaching army, he realized that he would never be able to fight it off; his only hope lay in humility. He put on sackcloth and went to Manuel's camp barefoot. There he threw himself in the dust in front of the emperor and begged for pardon. "He cried for mercy," notes William of Tyre, with distaste, "and he cried so long that everyone had nausea of it." Manuel let him weep